

Daily Bible Note

Date: July 24, 2026

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: Ezekiel 29:17–30:9

17 And it came to pass in the twenty-seventh year, in the first month, on the first day of the month, that the word of the Lord came to me, saying,

18 "Son of man, Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon caused his army to labor strenuously against Tyre; every head was made bald, and every shoulder rubbed raw; yet neither he nor his army received wages from Tyre, for the labor which they expended on it.

19 Therefore thus says the Lord God: 'Surely I will give the land of Egypt to Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon; he shall take away her wealth, carry off her spoil, and remove her pillage; and that will be the wages for his army.

20 I have given him the land of Egypt for his labor, because they worked for Me,' says the Lord God.

21 'In that day I will cause the horn of the house of Israel to spring forth, and I will open your mouth to speak in their midst. Then they shall know that I am the Lord.'

⟨Chapter 30⟩

1 The word of the Lord came to me again, saying,

2 "Son of man, prophesy and say, 'Thus says the Lord God: "Wail, 'Woe to the day!'

3 For the day is near, Even the day of the Lord is near; It will be a day of clouds, the time of the Gentiles.

4 The sword shall come upon Egypt, And great anguish shall be in Ethiopia, When the slain fall in Egypt, And they take away her wealth, And her foundations are broken down.

5 "Ethiopia, Libya, Lydia, all the mingled people, Chub, and the men of the lands who are allied, shall fall with them by the sword."

6 'Thus says the Lord: "Those who uphold Egypt shall fall, And the pride of her power shall come down. From Migdol to Syene Those within her shall fall by the sword," Says the Lord God.

7 "They shall be desolate in the midst of the desolate countries, And her cities shall be in the midst of the cities that are laid waste.

8 Then they will know that I am the Lord, When I have set a fire in Egypt And all her helpers are destroyed.

9 On that day messengers shall go forth from Me in ships To make the careless Ethiopians afraid, And great anguish shall come upon them, As on the day of Egypt; For indeed it is coming!"

II. Key Summary

- God says He will give the land of Egypt to Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon, as the wages his army did not receive from their labor against Tyre (29:17-20).
 - God announces that in that day He will cause the horn of the house of Israel to spring forth and open Ezekiel's mouth, so that they will know He is the Lord (29:21).
 - Through the prophet, God announces that "the day of the Lord" is near for Egypt: the sword will come, those who uphold Egypt will fall with her, and the pride of her power will come down (30:1-9).
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III. Passage Analysis

Behind history, God is the one in charge

Babylon was able to conquer Egypt not because it held military superiority, but because God used Babylon. [1]

Egypt, Tyre, and Babylon look like a few big powers wrestling for control, but the one who actually decides the outcome is God. Even a Babylonian king who does not know God is only a tool in His hand to get things done.

Pride in your own power won't hold you up

When we put our trust in human power and earthly strength instead of God, we are left disappointed and weakened, just as Judah's false hope in Egypt left them vulnerable. [2]

The very thing Egypt was proudest of — its own power — was exactly what fell first. Pinning your security on things that can change will always let you down in the end.

IV. Reflection Question

Is there something you feel like you'd be totally fine as long as you had it — maybe your looks, the likes and followers on your phone, or something you're really good at?

The thing Egypt was proudest of was its own power, and that was exactly what fell first; it's worth asking whether your sense of security rests on things that can change, or on the God who doesn't.

References

- [1] 華人基督徒查經資料網站 (ccbiblestudy.org), Commentary Collection on Ezekiel 30 (《聖經精讀本》), <https://www.ccbiblestudy.org/Old%20Testament/26Ezek/26GT30.htm>
- [2] Enduring Word, David Guzik Commentary on Ezekiel 29, <https://enduringword.com/bible-commentary/ezekiel-29/>